

work. This server did not have access to an outside network. Some of the Perl scripts that I had written required a few modules, but due to the restricted access, I could not install them. Even if I did get access, I didn't want to fiddle with the pre-installed version of Perl.

Where do we get it?

Go to www.strawberryperl.com and under the section *More downloads*, click on *Other releases: ZIP, Portable, older versions*. Download the 'Portable Zip' editions of Perl. I downloaded 32- and 64-bit portable versions for Perl 5.16.3 and 5.18.2.1 as well as a 32-bit version of 5.10.1. Once you have completed downloading them, unzip them to separate folders. This is what it looks like, in my case:

```
C:\>dir | find /I "perl"
02/23/2014 06:23 PM <DIR> my32bitperl1516
02/23/2014 02:12 AM <DIR> my32bitperl1518
02/19/2014 12:13 AM <DIR> my64bitperl1516
02/19/2014 12:16 AM <DIR> my64bitperl1518
02/19/2014 12:12 AM <DIR> myperl1510
02/18/2014 11:46 PM <DIR> Perl64
```

This is what each folder contains:

```
C:\my32bitperl1516 Folder For 32 Bit Perl Version 5.16.3.1
C:\my32bitperl1518 Folder For 32 Bit Perl Version 5.18.2.1
C:\my64bitperl1516 Folder For 64 Bit Perl Version 5.16.3.1
C:\my64bitperl1518 Folder For 64 Bit Perl Version 5.18.2.1
C:\myperl1510 Folder For 32 Bit Perl Version 5.10.1
C:\Perl64 Folder For 64 bit ActiveState Perl Version 5.16.3.1
```

You can give any name you wish to the folders when you unzip them. Just ensure that there are no spaces.

Let's *cd* to the *my32bitperl1518* folder and see what it contains:

```
C:\my32bitperl1518>dir
Volume in drive C is Windows7_OS
Volume Serial Number is 52DF-20FF
Directory of C:\my32bitperl1518

02/01/2014 09:00 PM <DIR> .
02/01/2014 09:00 PM <DIR> ..
05/04/2011 09:21 AM <DIR> c
01/07/2014 07:19 PM <DIR> cpan
02/02/2014 12:17 AM <DIR> data
01/07/2014 07:19 PM 9,575 DISTRIBUTIONS.txt
01/07/2014 07:19 PM <DIR> licenses
01/07/2014 04:50 PM <DIR> perl
12/03/2013 11:47 AM 2,661 portable.perl
11/15/2013 11:16 AM 915 portablesheell.bat
01/07/2014 07:39 PM 1,618 README.portable.txt
01/07/2014 07:19 PM <DIR> win32

4 File(s) 14,769 bytes
8 Dir(s) 138,036,543,488 bytes free
```

C:\my32bitperl1518>

Go through the *README.Portable.txt* file. It's got a lot of useful information. There are a few environment variables that you can add to make a Portable Perl load up automatically.

Next, run the *portablesheell.bat* file as shown and check the Perl version:

```
C:\my32bitperl1518>portablesheell.bat
Welcome to Strawberry Perl Portable Edition!
* URL - http://www.strawberryperl.com/
* see README.portable.TXT for more info
-----
Perl executable: C:\my32bitperl1518\perl\bin\perl.exe
Perl version : 5.18.2 / MSWin32-x86-multi-thread-64int
C:\my32bitperl1518>
C:\my32bitperl1518>perl --version
This is perl 5, version 18, subversion 2 (v5.18.2) built for
MSWin32-x86-multi-thread-64int
Copyright 1987-2013, Larry Wall
Perl may be copied only under the terms of either the
Artistic License or the
GNU General Public License, which may be found in the Perl 5
source kit.
Complete documentation for Perl, including FAQ lists, should
be found on
this system using "man perl" or "perldoc perl". If you have
access to the
Internet, point your browser at http://www.perl.org/, the
Perl Home Page.
C:\my32bitperl1518>
```

Note how easily I can switch to this Perl Version. It also installed gcc and make. Here's the output:

```
C:\my32bitperl1518>gcc --version
gcc (release with patches / build 20130526 by strawberryperl.
com) 4.7.3
Copyright (C) 2012 Free Software Foundation, Inc.
This is free software; see the source for copying conditions.
There is NO
warranty; not even for MERCHANTABILITY or FITNESS FOR A
PARTICULAR PURPOSE.
C:\my32bitperl1518>make --version
GNU Make 3.82
Built for i686-w64-mingw32
Copyright (C) 2010 Free Software Foundation, Inc.
License GPLv3+: GNU GPL version 3 or later <http://gnu.org/
licenses/gpl.html>
This is free software: you are free to change and redistribute
it.
There is NO WARRANTY, to the extent permitted by law.
C:\my32bitperl1518>
```